

90-DAY SOFTWARE TESTING CAREER ROADMAP

Test Plan Template

A concise, professional plan covering scope, approach, risks and exit criteria.

Introduction

A test plan sets out what you will test, how, by when, and what "done" means. It keeps the team aligned and protects you from scope and timeline disputes later.

Instructions

- Define scope: what is in and explicitly out.
- Describe the test approach and the levels/types of testing.
- Capture entry and exit criteria so "done" is unambiguous.
- List risks and how you will mitigate them.

Real QA Example (extract)

Section	Example content
Scope (in)	Checkout, payment, order confirmation
Scope (out)	Admin reporting (unchanged this release)
Approach	Risk-based manual testing + API checks + regression of impacted areas
Entry criteria	Build deployed to test; smoke test passes
Exit criteria	All high-priority cases run; no open critical defects; regression passed
Key risk	Payment integration changes — mitigation: deep test of payment paths

Blank Reusable Template

- 1. Overview & objectives
- 2. Scope (in / out)
- 3. Test approach (levels, types, tools)
- 4. Environment & test data

- 5. Entry criteria
- 6. Exit criteria
- 7. Risks & mitigations
- 8. Schedule & responsibilities
- 9. Deliverables

Best Practice Tips

- Keep it as short as it can be while still useful — a plan nobody reads helps no one.
- Agree entry/exit criteria in writing, early.
- Tie the approach to risk, not to "test everything".

Common Mistakes

- No clear exit criteria, so testing "finishes" when time runs out.
- Scope with no explicit out-of-scope list.
- Risks listed but never mitigated or revisited.

INSIDE STLC PRO TIP

Clear entry/exit criteria are your best defence against being blamed for a rushed release. Put them in the plan and get sign-off.